

who walked like hamsters inside huge wheels. As the wheels turned, they pulled on ropes that raised and lowered the building stones into place.

Seats, safety, and sun

The Colosseum could seat about 45,000 people, with room for a further 5,000 standing. People

were seated according to their status in Roman society—the more important you were, the nearer to the killing you sat. Of course, the emperor had the best seat in the building, right at the front of one of the arena's long sides. His family, friends, and favorites sat nearby. Women, slaves, and the poor

SPECTATORS REACHED THEIR SEATS VIA CORRIDORS AND STAIRCASES.

